

Micro ATX boards				
Brand	Gigabyte	ASRock	ASUS	ASUS
Model No.	Z87M-D3H	Z87M Extreme 4	Gryphon Z87	Maximus VI Gene
Warranty (no. of months)	36	38	60	36
Price (MOP in ₹)	10,300	10,999	14,600 (excl. armor kit)	16,750
Features (Out of 50)	16.1	18.25	19	29.3
Overclocking and BIOS Options (Out of 25)	12.5	10	13.75	18.75
Board Layout (Out of 20)	12.3	14.4	14.3	15.2
Package Bundle (Out of 5)	0.9	1.8	1.8	2.7
Grand Total (Out of 100)	41.8	44.45	48.85	65.95
Specifications				
Max. Memory Supported (GB) / DIMMs	32 / 4	32 / 4	32 / 4	32 / 4
No. of SATA 3 Ports	0 / 6	0 / 6	0 / 6	0 / 8
No. of PCIe 2.0 x16/PCIe 3.0 x16 slots	1/1	1/2	1/2	0/2
No. of PCI/PCIe x1/PCIe x4	2/0/0	0/1/0	0/1/0	0/0/1
Multi GPU (SLI/CrossFire) Support	N / Y	Y / Y	Y / Y	Y / Y
Integrated Audio Controller	Realtek ALC892	Realtek ALC1150	Realtek ALC892	ROG SupremeFX
Audio section isolated (Y/N)	N	N	N	Y
Optical S/PDIF Port	N	Y	Y	Y
Coaxial S/PDIF Port	N	N	N	0
LAN Ports / On-board WiFi	1/N	1/N	1/N	1/Y
USB 2.0/USB 3.0/eSATA ports	2/4/0	4/4/1	4/4/0	4/6/0
No. of Fan Connectors	4	5	7	5
Clear CMOS Button	N	N	N	N
All Solid State Caps (Y/N)	Y	Y	Y	Y
Power and Reset Buttons (Y/N)	N	N	N	Y
UEFI BIOS (Y/N)	Y	Y	Y	Y
USB 2.0 header	3	2	2	2
USB 3.0 header	1	1	1	1
POST error code LED	N	N	N	Y
HDMI/D-Sub/DVI/DP	1/1/1/0	1/1/1/0	1/0/1/0	1/0/0/0
mSATA Connector	N	N	N	N
Dual BIOS	Y	N	Y	Y
USB Charger	N	N	N	Y
Form Factor	mATX	mATX	mATX	mATX
Overclocking and BIOS Options				
Overclocking button	N	N	N	N
Overclocking Utility	Y	Y	Y	Y
Overclocking Presets	Y	Y	Y	Y
Overclocking via an App	N	N	N	Y
Voltage check points	N	N	N	Y
Keyboard shortcuts	N	N	Y	Y
Separate home page	Y	N	Y	Y
Board Layout				
Region around the CPU	8	8	8	8
Location of SATA ports	5	8	8	8
Placement of Memory modules	8	8	8	8
PCIe slots	7	7	6.5	8
VRM Heatsink Quality	7	7.5	7	8
Southbridge heatsink quality	6	7	7.5	8
PCIe switches (Y/N)	N	N	N	N
Package Bundle				
No. of SATA cables	2	4	4	6
I/O Shield	Y	Y	Y	Y
CrossFire / SLI Bridge	N / N	N / Y	N / Y	N / Y
WiFi Antenna	N	N	N	Y
Performance (For ref. only)				
Cinebench R11.5				
OpenGL/CPU (All cores)	30.68 / 8.47	26.61 / 8.1	29/8.56	30.5/8.59
3D Mark 11 (1280x1024, Entry)	2892	2767	2835	2851
WinRAR 4.0 (Multi threaded) (KB/s)	3745	3764	3674	3699
Audio encoding (in secs)	47.27	47.21	46.82	46.8
Game (in FPS)				
Resident Evil 5 (1280x1024, med)	69.9	62.6	71.2	70.2
Resident Evil 5 (1680x1050, med)	53.7	48.2	54	53.5

are well laid out and do not look too flashy. The Extreme 6 of course has better heatsinks, more number of SATA 3 ports and larger power/reset buttons. The PCIe x16 ports on both the boards are both rated as x16 for single card, x8/x8 for two cards and x8/x4/x4 for three cards. While the Extreme 4 has two PCIe x1 slots, the Extreme 6 has a single PCIe x1 slot and the space between the PCIe x16 and PCI slot is filled with an mSATA port. Both the boards apart from having the Realtek ALC1150 audio codec, also has a pair of TI NE5532 headset amplifier which supports upto 600 ohm headphones. Both boards have isolated audio sections to help prevent digital noise from the board affect the analogue sound signals. Both boards come with an HDMI-in port which allows you to feed two inputs to your monitor and switch between your system and the other input. So for instance you can connect your PlayStation to use the monitor and can switch to your system using a hotkey.

With the Z87-A, ASUS is going in for a new colour scheme – black and golden/yellow as opposed to the blue coloured theme on the mainstream boards from the previous generation. The Z87-A has minimal heatsink design on the VRMs and the southbridge, even the arrangement of the SATA ports was a bit unconventional – only one double SATA slot and four single-SATA slots. Layout is quite decent with enough room around the CPU region and PCIe x16 slots also have at least one other slot between them to easily take in a dual-slot card without blocking the neighbouring PCIe x16 slot. Although it lacks power/reset buttons, it has buttons for checking DRAM